CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

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Automotive Services

Collision Repair · General Auto Repair · Tire & Wheel · Auto Glass · Towing & Roadside · Car Wash & Detailing

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

RULE

Washington's rewritten claims rules took effect October 18: insurers have five business days to answer a shop's supplement in writing, and total-loss comparable searches stop at 150 miles.

Washington's amended claims-handling rules took effect October 18, two months after the insurance commissioner adopted them on August 18. They change what a repair shop can demand in writing and how fast an insurer must answer on first-party auto claims.

On supplements, an insurer must answer a shop's supplemental estimate and final invoice in writing within five business days. Shops and claimants cannot be forced onto internet-only claim platforms, and a disputed virtual inspection must be followed by an in-person one within five business days.

On total losses, comparable-vehicle searches are capped at 150 miles, condition deductions need photos and documentation, and rental coverage must run at least seven days after payment is sent. Insurers must explain storage and towing coverage in writing within five business days of notice.

The claim clock also changed: a first-party claim must be accepted or denied within 30 calendar days of notification, replacing 15 working days from a completed proof of loss. The old per se rule that treated denying an estimate solely because of a shop's hourly rate as arbitrary was removed, which favors insurers.

What to do about it: Print the five-business-day supplement and final-invoice response requirement and hand it to every estimator who works a Washington carrier. Log the date and time each supplement is sent, so a missed written response is documented the day it is missed. Tell total-loss customers about the seven-day rental floor and the 150-mile comparable cap, and photograph every condition the carrier deducts for. If a carrier cuts an estimate over your hourly rate, get the reason in writing, because the protection that treated that as arbitrary is gone. Shops outside Washington can use the rule as a reference when asking regional carriers for written response times.

Washington claims-handling rules change Oct. 18, 2026 · Washington insurance regulations take effect Oct. 18 · Washington adopts extensive claims-handling changes

COLLISION REPAIR

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

Vermont's insurance regulator found shops charge an average $67 an hour against the $60.50 insurers pay, and urged set deadlines for answering supplements, which are filed on about 95% of repairs.

Why it matters: Autobody News reported October 22 on a 61-page Vermont report that appears to date from December 2025 (its file name carries 12-30-2025) and whose recommendations are preliminary. Surveyed shop rates ran $60 to $84 an hour; a survey of 20 insurers found an average payment of $60.50. Supplement review adds more than seven days, insurers were not able to provide written procedures or source materials, and the report recommends timeframes for answering and paying supplements and tighter direct repair program rules, with more defined recommendations expected in 2027. Log each supplement's send date, response date and rate dispute now.

Autobody News: Vermont report on labor rates and DRPs

MONEY

CCC Intelligent Solutions agreed October 15 to be taken private by a GTCR-led group including Elliott at $7.75 a share in cash, an enterprise value of about $6.1 billion.

Why it matters: The price is about 44% above CCC's July 9 unaffected close, and Autobody News reported October 16 that closing is expected in the first quarter of 2027 after Hart-Scott-Rodino clearance and a stockholder vote. CCC stays public and independent until then, and its third-quarter results are due October 29 with no call. Executives quoted say the owners will push AI tools and expand the repair and insurer network. Pull your CCC ONE contract, note the renewal date and price-change language, and ask your rep in writing whether 2027 pricing is fixed.

Autobody News: CCC agrees to $6.1B sale to GTCR group

GENERAL AUTO REPAIR

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

California's repair bureau revised its airbag rule to cover individual airbag parts and to bar installing or selling any airbag under a safety recall; the revised rule is expected to take effect January 1, 2027.

Why it matters: Autobody News reported October 13 that the Bureau of Automotive Repair posted modified Section 3367 text September 2 and took comments through September 17. Parts must not contradict a current automaker position statement, and for dismantler parts shops must verify that control units and impact sensors never triggered a deployment. Unchanged: OEM-condition restoration, buying only from the OEM, an authorized supplier or a licensed dismantler, and keeping receipts for every part. The rule is pending state review. California shops should add a recall check and a deployment-history question to every airbag parts order.

Autobody News: BAR revises airbag rule

REGULATION

FCA US is recalling 265,512 Ram ProMaster vans over wiring corrosion that can cut power steering assist, and Volkswagen 22,524 ID.4s with a battery fire risk and no remedy yet.

Why it matters: Autobody News reported October 14 on NHTSA campaigns 26V621 and 26V630. ProMaster owners get interim letters starting November 17, and dealers will inspect each van and replace the harness and steering gear where needed. ID.4 owners are told to keep charging at or below 80% until a fix exists, with interim letters expected November 27. Both remedies run through dealers, so check VIN recall status before you quote steering or high-voltage battery diagnosis, and tell fleet and EV customers the repair belongs at a dealer.

Autobody News: Ram ProMaster, VW ID.4 recalls

TIRE & WHEEL

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

Northcoast Research's tire cost index puts September input costs about 25% above a year earlier and projects the cost to build a tire up 27.8% in the fourth quarter, as dealers report weaker retail activity.

Why it matters: Modern Tire Dealer's October 14 column puts natural rubber about 43% and oil prices about 60% above a year ago in September, against 18.8% overall in August. If prices hold, the cost to build a tire rises about 19.8% in the third quarter and 27.8% in the fourth, though these spot figures may lag tiremaker results. Dealers report year-to-date retail activity below 2025, and tier-three brands grew faster than tier-one and tier-two. Ask your distributor now which lines are covered by coming price notices, and price winter inventory before they land.

Modern Tire Dealer: retail activity continues to decline

DEMAND

Michelin reported October 21 that Michelin-brand replacement tire volume rose 4% through September while group tire volume fell 0.8% on weaker original-equipment sales.

Why it matters: Modern Tire Dealer reported nine-month Michelin Group sales of $21.5 billion, up 1%. Passenger and light-truck sales were above $11.6 billion, down 1%, with replacement growth led by the Michelin brand in 18-inch and larger sizes. Truck and bus replacement fell slightly in Michelin's Americas region, with lower freight demand in North America. Compare your own 18-inch-and-larger mix against that trend this week, and if you sell commercial tires, plan for soft truck-tire replacement volume.

Modern Tire Dealer: Michelin reports revenue increase

AUTO GLASS

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

CCC announced October 20 that ADAS calibration recommendations from five providers, including asTech, Azimuth, Opus, Kinetic and Revv, now appear inside CCC ONE estimates at no added charge.

Why it matters: Autobody News reported October 23 that CCC ONE customers with a contract with a participating provider can see the recommendations through the Diagnostics button, and insurers using Advanced or Intelligent Estimating in APEX can see them too. CCC says the recommendations reflect automaker requirements. Shops and insurers will see the same calibration prompt on an estimate. Ask your CCC rep whether your calibration provider participates, and price calibration as its own line so a prompt becomes a paid line.

Autobody News: CCC adds calibration guidelines to CCC ONE

SUPPLY

Autel said October 19 its Nissan software now reaches protected functions, including ADAS calibration, on 2023-2026 models such as the Rogue and Sentra, and added an MA800 mobile calibration system.

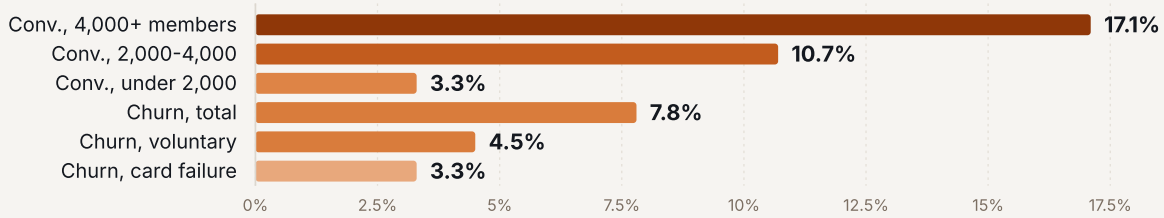
Why it matters: Repairer Driven News reported that access runs through Autel's AutoAuth process, licensed through the Equipment and Tool Institute, and requires an active Autel software subscription and an AutoAuth account. The releases are Autel Nissan V7.40 and Nissan ADAS V5.20, and the article names Auto Glass Week 2026 as the demonstration event. Autel says coverage varies by vehicle, module and procedure. If you sublet Nissan calibrations, ask your calibration vendor whether the new coverage applies, and verify each vehicle and procedure before quoting.

Repairer Driven News: Autel gains Nissan CONSULT 4 access

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / MEMBER CONVERSION

Car washes with 4,000 or more members converted 17.1% of retail customers to members in the third quarter, more than five times the 3.3% at sites under 2,000.

Retail-to-member conversion rate and average monthly churn, percent; Rinsed Q3 2026 Quarterly Car Wash Industry Report, more than 3,000 locations, reported October 22, 2026



Conversion rises with member count, from 3.3% at sites under 2,000 members to 17.1% at 4,000 or more. Monthly churn of 7.8% splits into 4.5% voluntary cancellations and 3.3% card failures, so about 42% of lost members are payment failures (3.3 of 7.8). Failed-payment recovery is the first place to look for members you already won. ICA: Rinsed releases Q3 2026 industry report

TOWING & ROADSIDE

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

California's repair bureau has a rule package that would require customer authorization of towing fees before a tow, on a separate document for shops with a motor carrier permit, and storage fees based on a shop's own costs.

Why it matters: Autobody News reported October 13 that the towing package, awaiting agency review, requires customer authorization before a tow; shops with a motor carrier permit must use a document separate from the repair authorization, and storage and towing must be separate invoice lines. The storage package bases fees on the shop's own costs, requires posted daily rates and a maximum daily rate reported at renewal, and the bureau plans a public tool showing average and median storage rates by locale. The storage rule is expected January 1, 2027. Split your authorization forms and document your storage costs now.

Autobody News: BAR storage and towing packages advance

DEMAND

NOAA's October 8 outlook gives better than 83% odds that a strong El Niño lasts into January-March 2027, which typically steers storms across the southern United States.

Why it matters: Autobody News reported October 22 on the outlook. NOAA says it makes typical impacts more likely, not certain, and the next update is November 12. The Federal Highway Administration puts about 24% of weather-related crashes on snow-, slush- or ice-covered roads. Northern states often see above-normal winter temperatures, while the Northern Rockies and the Ohio and Tennessee valleys tend to be drier. Southern operators should plan driver coverage and truck readiness for storm days; northern operators should not budget a snow-heavy winter before the November 12 update.

Autobody News: strong El Nino and shop volume

CAR WASH & DETAILING

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Rinsed's third-quarter report, reported October 22, shows same-store retail revenue down 9.6% year over year, the largest decline in five quarters, while membership revenue rose 9.8%.

Why it matters: Across more than 3,000 locations, members now make up about 71% of same-store revenue, up from 66% a year earlier, and same-store sales grew 3.2%, the slowest in five quarters. Sites open at least two years grew 1.1%. Average monthly churn was 7.8%: 4.5% voluntary cancellations and 3.3% credit card failures, which rose fastest, 5.4% year over year. Compare your membership share and failed-card rate against these, and start with failed-payment retries and card-update reminders, the churn you can recover without winning a customer back.

ICA: Rinsed releases Q3 2026 industry report

DEMAND

Express Wash Concepts bought three CleanHub sites in Metro Detroit, taking it to 147 express locations in six states, and suspended member billing while the sites close until mid-November.

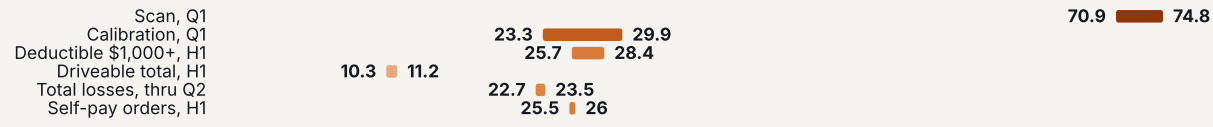
Why it matters: The sites in Shelby Township, Sterling Heights and Oxford close for equipment, technology and branding work and reopen mid-November as Clean Express Auto Wash. Pulse 2.0 reported the deal October 10. CleanHub unlimited members get the Clean-est Ultra Unlimited Wash Club at $20 a month for six months, with billing suspended during the closure and free washes at other Express Wash Concepts sites.

Express Wash Concepts acquires three CleanHub washes

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / YEAR AGO TO NOW

Calibration appeared on 29.9% of repairable appraisals in the first quarter, up from 23.3% a year earlier, and every other CCC marker in this chart also rose.

Each bar runs from the year-ago share to the 2026 share, percent; CCC Intelligent Solutions mid-year update to its 2026 Crash Course, reported October 19, 2026 (scan and calibration Q1; deductible and self-pay H1; total losses through Q2)

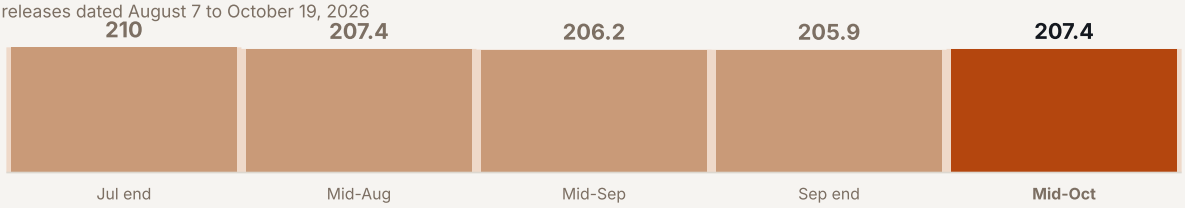


Calibration gained 6.6 points, scans 3.9, deductibles of $1,000 or more 2.7 and driveable total losses 0.9. The total-loss and self-pay year-ago values are the 2026 level less the reported gains of 0.8 and 0.5 points. More calibration lines raise the ticket; larger deductibles and self-pay orders put more of the bill on the customer. Repairer Driven News: CCC mid-year trends update

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / WHOLESALE USED VALUES

Wholesale used-vehicle values slid from 210 at the end of July to 205.9 at the end of September, then firmed to 207.4 in mid-October.

Manheim Used Vehicle Value Index, adjusted for mix, mileage and seasonality; month-end and mid-month readings from Cox Automotive releases dated August 7 to October 19, 2026



Wholesale used-vehicle values fell 4.1 points from 210 at the end of July to 205.9 at the end of September, then rose to 207.4 in the first half of October. The mid-October reading is preliminary; Cox's next full monthly release is November 6. Cox Automotive: Manheim index releases, Aug-Oct 2026

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

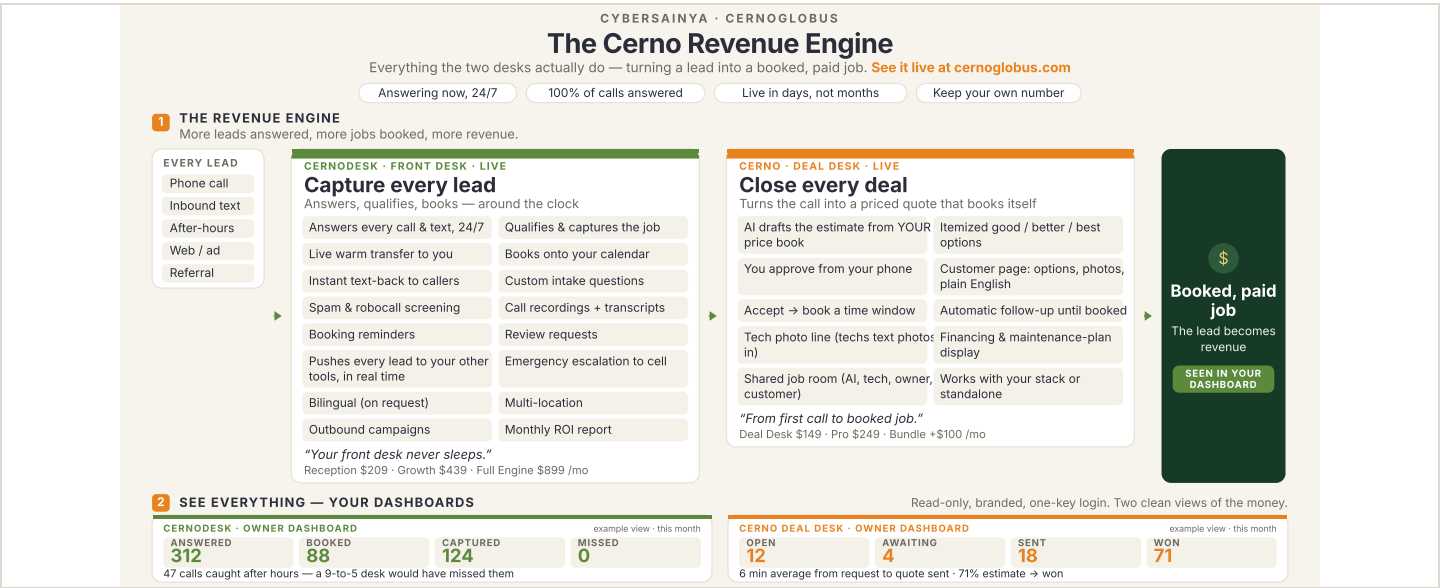
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a shop owner. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A shop that emails estimates, repair orders and parts invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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